

The Montessori Classroom Setup Guide

*An AMI-aligned guide to the prepared environment
for children ages 3 to 6*

Montessori Life Skills
montessorilifeskillsapp.com

Six Principles of the Prepared Environment

Everything in a Montessori classroom exists for a reason. These six principles govern every choice you make when preparing the space.

Order

The environment must be ordered, because the child between three and six is in the sensitive period for order. Every material has a fixed place on the shelf, and the child always returns it there.

Beauty

The room must be beautiful -- light, airy, with fresh flowers, plants, and carefully chosen pictures hung at the child's eye level.

Reality

Tools must be real and they must work. The child drinks from a real glass, pours from a real ceramic jug, sweeps with a real broom.

Freedom within limits

The child is free to choose work and repeat it -- provided the work is not misused and does not disturb others.

Child-sized proportions

Every piece of furniture and every tool is proportioned to the child and light enough for the child to move.

One of each material

There is only one of each material in the room. This teaches waiting, turn-taking, and respect for another's work.

The Curriculum Areas

Practical Life

The first area. Everything begins here.

- Preliminary exercises -- spooning, pouring, carrying a tray, opening and closing

- Care of th

Practical Life is offered exclusively at the start. No other curriculum area is introduced until the child's Practical Life work is settled.

Sensorial

Introduced once Practical Life work is settled.

- Visual -- pink tower, brown stair, red rods, knobbed cylinders

- Tactile --

Each material isolates a single sensory quality and carries its own control of error.

Language

Runs alongside Sensorial, once speech is confident.

- Enrichment of vocabulary -- classified cards, three-period lessons

- Sound ga

Writing precedes reading in the AMI sequence.

Mathematics

Introduced when the child shows readiness.

- Numbers one to ten -- number rods, sandpaper numbers, spindle box, cards and counters

- The deci

Every quantity is first presented concretely; the symbol always follows.

Culture

Woven through the environment from the start.

- Geography -- land and water forms, globes, puzzle maps

- Botany --

Geography begins with the whole and moves to the parts.

How the Shelves Are Arranged

- Materials are arranged left to right, top to bottom, simplest to most complex.

- Every act

The Role of the Adult

- Prepare the environment, then step back. The adult is the link between the child and the environment -- not the centre of it.

- Observe

The Essentials Checklist

- Low open shelves, no higher than the child's shoulder

- Child-size

When you are ready for the full AMI sequence -- eight curriculum areas and hundreds of activities with step-by-step presentations -- it is waiting inside the Montessori Life Skills app.